



## HUNGARY

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|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Capital city:</b> Budapest                    |
| <b>Area:</b> 35,919 sq miles (93,030 sq km)      |
| <b>Population:</b> 9,900,000                     |
| <b>Official language:</b> Hungarian (Magyar)     |
| <b>Major religions:</b> Christian 71%, other 29% |
| <b>Government:</b> Multiparty democracy          |
| <b>Currency:</b> Forint                          |
| <b>Adult literacy rate:</b> 99%                  |
| <b>Life expectancy:</b> 72 years                 |
| <b>People per doctor:</b> 345                    |
| <b>Televisions:</b> 437 per 1,000 people         |

Flowers being gathered at a vast flower farm run by a cooperative



Paprika

Paprika is used in many recipes, and Hungary grows over 40 percent of the world's paprika.



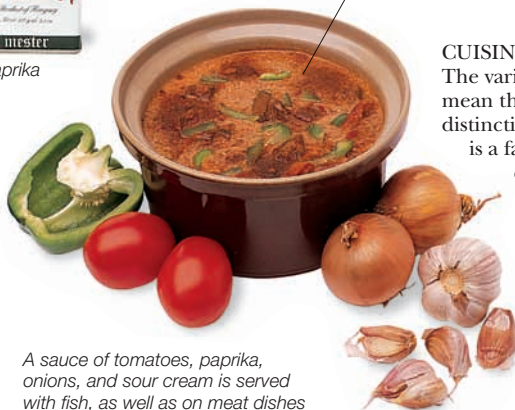
Goulash was originally a basic dish eaten by shepherds.

## AGRICULTURE

Since this fertile land is warmed by hot summers and short, mild winters, a wide variety of crops are found here. Cereals flourish, as in other parts of Central Europe, but Hungary also produces sunflowers, fruits, and vegetables, as well as olives, figs, and grapes – there is a thriving wine industry. However, the changeover from a communist to a capitalist economy has caused problems.

## CUISINE

The varied crops produced in Hungary mean that it has developed some distinctive dishes. Hungary's national dish is a famous beef and vegetable mix called goulash, served as a stew or a thick soup. A hot red pepper called paprika is added to give goulash its spicy flavor. Other examples of the rich and heavy cuisine include carp in paprika sauce, pastry filled with liver pâté, and grilled meats served with stuffed peppers.



A sauce of tomatoes, paprika, onions, and sour cream is served with fish, as well as on meat dishes such as goulash.

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A BROAD, FERTILE PLAIN sweeps across much of this country, while gentle hills and low mountains are found in the northern and western parts. The most southern country in Central Europe, Hungary has been home to many different peoples, including Germans, Slovaks, Serbs, Croats, Romanians, and Roma. Most Hungarians, however, are descended from the Magyars, who were fierce nomadic horsemen. After World War II, the communists established a harsh rule here, putting down a rebellion in 1956. A democratic government is now in place.



## THERMAL SPRINGS AND SPAS

The grand architecture of Budapest's old Turkish baths is a distant echo of the country's past as part of the Ottoman Empire. There are baths and spas all across Hungary, centered on the hundreds of warm springs that gush naturally from the ground. Since ancient times, people have flocked to bathe in these mineral-rich waters, often seeking to cure their ailments.



The parliament buildings on the Danube River in Budapest

## BUDAPEST

If you were to take a cruise ship through Budapest along the great Danube River, you would discover that the capital is actually two cities. Buda, on one bank of the river, is the old royal capital, filled with ancient buildings. Across the water lies Pest, the heart of modern business and political life, where the government buildings are found. Budapest has more foreign visitors than any other Central European capital, and almost two-thirds of foreign money invested in Hungary is centered in the city.

The wine industry is modernizing with great speed and is continuing to expand its export markets.



## INDUSTRY

Hungary's many industries produce metals, chemicals, and vehicles as well as textiles and electrical goods. Since a democratic government gained control in 1990, the country has had to compete in a worldwide market. Many firms have been privatized, and some industry has declined. However, Hungary's population has highly developed skills, especially in science and engineering, and it attracts more foreign investment per person than any other country in Central Europe.

## Find out more

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